Flexible ways to participate in class

Can students participate in different ways?

ACCESSIBILITY / TEACHING

ONE-PAGE TEACHING GUIDE

WHAT IS IT?

Different forms of participation are equally legitimate without requiring disclosure, adapted to class/room constraints

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

Accessibility is about usability, not just technical availability. A resource, room or activity can exist while still costing some students far more energy to perceive, navigate, understand or act on. Repeated friction sends a message about who the default user is.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “The information exists, but finding and using it takes more effort than learning it.”
- “I have to keep asking for a version I can actually use.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Offer more than one way to contribute, such as speaking, posting or sharing through smaller groups.
- Make participation expectations explicit without forcing one style of presence.
- Avoid treating quiet participation as no participation.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

Students can respond verbally, through a shared document or in small-group discussion, depending on the activity and room setup.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

In this course, we aim to offer more than one legitimate way for students to participate in learning activities. If the way a class or learning activity is organised makes it harder for you to participate or understand what…

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